

Sagax — Brand & UI/UX Guide

1. Brand Identity

Name

Sagax (Latin: keen, shrewd, perceptive). Pronounced /'sa.gaks/. The name references the instinct of a hunting dog reading terrain before others see what's there — perceptive intelligence applied to strategic decisions.

Tagline

Game Theory You Play, Not Read

Brand Position

Sagax is a strategy room, not a classroom. The platform teaches game theory through interactive simulators framed with real-world finance scenarios. The brand sits between a Bloomberg terminal and an academic journal — analytically rigorous, visually restrained, and experientially hands-on.

Brand Personality

- **Sharp** — precise, economical, no wasted space or words
- **Grounded** — rooted in real financial decisions, not abstract puzzles
- **Earned confidence** — the platform trusts users to make decisions before explaining theory
- **Warm restraint** — serious but not sterile, dark but not cold

Brand Is / Is Not

Sagax IS	Sagax IS NOT
A strategy room	A classroom
Bloomberg meets game board	Duolingo meets arcade
Professional and analytical	Playful and gamified
Interactive and experiential	Passive and lecture-based
Understated confidence	Loud self-promotion
Warm dark tones	Cold tech-black or sterile white
Monospace data, serif brand name	Rounded sans-serif everything

2. Color System

Philosophy

The palette draws from three visual worlds: dark wood game boards (chess, Go, poker), financial terminal screens (Bloomberg amber-on-black), and handwritten strategy notebooks (ink on warm paper). Every color earns its place. Decorative color does not exist in Sagax.

Core Palette

Backgrounds

Token	Hex	Usage
bg-primary	#0E0D0B	Page background. Warm near-black with a brown undertone, not blue-black.
bg-surface	#1A1816	Cards, panels, interactive areas. Distinct from background but not loud.
bg-surface-hover	#222019	Hover state for interactive surfaces.
bg-elevated	#2A2620	Dropdowns, tooltips, popovers. One step lighter.

Text

Token	Hex	Usage
text-primary	#DDD8CE	Body text, headings. Warm off-white, not blue-white.
text-secondary	#908A7E	Descriptions, supporting text. Readable but recessive.
text-muted	#5E584E	Labels, captions, metadata. Present but quiet.
text-faint	#3E3A34	Disabled states, decorative text, footer legalese.

Accent — Amber

Token	Hex	Usage
amber	 #C8963E	Primary brand color. Logo, primary CTAs, key data highlights, active states.
amber-strong	 #DAAB52	Hover state for amber elements.
amber-muted	#C8963E1A	Amber at 10% opacity. Backgrounds for amber-tagged elements.

Semantic — Game Outcomes

Token	Hex	Usage
green	 #6AAD7C	Cooperation, profit, positive outcomes. Muted sage, not neon.
green-muted	#6AAD7C1A	Green at 10% opacity. Backgrounds for positive states.
red	 #CC5F5F	Defection, loss, negative outcomes. Restrained, not alarming.
red-muted	#CC5F5F1A	Red at 10% opacity. Backgrounds for negative states.
steel	 #7A9CC6	Secondary analytical accent. Used for player identification, category tags.
steel-muted	#7A9CC620	Steel at 10% opacity.

Borders

Token	Hex	Usage
border	 #2A2620	Default borders. Cards, tables, dividers.
border-strong	 #3A362E	Emphasized borders. Inputs, active states, hover.

Color Rules

- 1. **No pure black (#000000) or pure white (#FFFFFF) anywhere.** The warmth of the palette depends on every shade carrying a slight brown/amber undertone.
- 2. **Semantic colors appear only in context.** Green and red are reserved for game outcomes (cooperation/defection, profit/loss). They never appear as decorative accents or branding elements.

3. **Amber is used with restraint.** It marks the single most important element on any screen — the primary CTA, the key score, the brand name. If everything is amber, nothing is.
 4. **Muted color backgrounds (10% opacity tokens) replace solid fills for status indicators.** A positive result gets a green-muted background with green text, never a solid green block.
 5. **When in doubt, use a neutral.** Most of the interface should be bg-primary, bg-surface, and text tones. Color is the exception, not the rule.
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3. Typography

Philosophy

Three typeface roles, each doing a specific job. The display face (serif) conveys authority and timelessness — it appears rarely and always at the brand level. The body face (sans-serif) is invisible infrastructure — it delivers content without calling attention to itself. The data face (monospace) is the workhorse — game theory is quantitative, and the numbers are the content.

Type Stack

Role	Typeface	Fallback Stack
Display	Georgia	'Times New Roman', serif
Body	Inter	system-ui, -apple-system, 'Segoe UI', sans-serif
Data	SF Mono	'Cascadia Code', Consolas, monospace

Type Scale

Name	Size	Weight	Face	Tracking	Line Height	Usage
display-xl	34px	400	Display	-0.02em	1.15	Homepage hero title only
display-lg	20px	400	Display	-0.01em	1.3	Simulator titles, section headings
display-sm	15px	400	Display	0	1.35	Card headings when serif tone is needed
body-lg	15px	400	Body	0	1.7	Hero descriptions, lead paragraphs
body	13.5px	400	Body	0	1.65	Primary body text, descriptions
body-sm	12.5px	400	Body	0	1.55	Card descriptions, secondary content
body-xs	12px	400	Body	0	1.5	Hints, helper text, footnotes
label	10px	600	Body	0.12em	1.2	Section labels, form labels. Always uppercase.
tag	10px	600	Body	0.07em	1.2	Category tags. Always uppercase.
data-xl	28-36px	600	Data	0	1.1	Hero numbers (auction signals, key scores)
data-lg	22px	600	Data	0	1.2	Score displays, stat cards
data	13px	400-600	Data	0	1.4	Payoff matrix cells, bid values, round numbers
data-sm	12px	400	Data	0	1.4	History table content, inline data

Typography Rules

1. **Georgia appears in exactly two places:** the brand name "Sagax" and simulator titles. Everywhere else is Inter or monospace. Overusing the serif dilutes its presence.

2. **All labels are uppercase with wide letter-spacing.** This is the signposting system — labels orient the user within the interface. They should be visually distinct from content text without being loud.
 3. **Numbers are always monospace.** Any number that the user needs to compare, track, or evaluate (payoffs, bids, scores, rounds) is set in the data face. This ensures tabular alignment and signals "this is data, not prose."
 4. **Font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums** is set on all data elements. This ensures digits align vertically in tables and score displays.
 5. **No bold body text for emphasis.** If something needs emphasis, restructure the layout or use a label above it. Bold text within paragraphs creates visual noise.
 6. **No italic except for strategy descriptions** (brief explanatory text under opponent/parameter selectors).
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4. Layout

Grid

All content lives within a single column, max-width 880px, centered with 24px horizontal padding. This is not a multi-column dashboard — it's a focused, linear reading and playing experience. The narrow measure keeps body text comfortable and simulators contained.



Spacing Scale

Token	Value	Usage
space-1	4px	Tight gaps: tag padding, inline element separation
space-2	8px	Small gaps: between pills, between icon and text
space-3	12px	Medium gaps: padding inside small components
space-4	16px	Standard gaps: paragraph spacing, card internal padding
space-5	20px	Card padding, section sub-spacing
space-6	24px	Page horizontal padding, major section padding
space-8	32px	Section separation within a page
space-10	40px	Hero-to-content gap
space-14	56px	Major section breaks on the homepage

Spacing Rules

- 1. **Vertical rhythm is generous.** Sections breathe. The space between major sections (space-14: 56px) is deliberately large — it prevents the dark interface from feeling dense or claustrophobic.
- 2. **Horizontal spacing is tight.** Within a row of pills, stats, or buttons, gaps are small (6-10px). This clusters related controls into a visual unit.
- 3. **Cards have 18-20px internal padding.** Consistent across all card types (simulator cards, stat cards, result panels, insight cards).

Border Radius

Token	Value	Usage
radius-sm	2px	Table cells, history rows, bid bars
radius-md	3px	Cards, panels, buttons, inputs
radius-full	100px	Pills, tags, filter chips

Sagax uses minimal border radius. The 3px default is barely perceptible — just enough to avoid harsh corners without looking rounded or soft. The full-radius pills are the exception, reserved for small interactive chips (filter selectors, opponent pills, tags).

5. Components

Buttons

Primary (amber)

- Background: amber (( #C8963E))
- Text: #111 (near-black)
- Padding: 8px 18px
- Radius: 3px
- Font: body, 13px, weight 500
- Hover: amber-strong (( #DAAB52))
- Disabled: 35% opacity, no pointer

Semantic (green / red)

- Used exclusively for game decisions (Hold Price, Undercut, Submit Bid)
- Background: green (( #6AAD7C)) or red (( #CC5F5F))
- Text: #111 for green, #fff for red
- Same sizing as primary
- These buttons are never used outside simulator interactions

Outline

- Background: transparent
- Border: 1.5px solid border (( #2A2620))
- Text: text-secondary (( #908A7E))
- Used for secondary actions: Reset, Clear, Back
- Hover: border-strong

Ghost

- Background: transparent, no border
- Text: text-muted (( #5E584E))
- Used for tertiary navigation: "← Back to library"
- Hover: text-secondary

Stat Cards

Stat cards display a single metric (score, P&L, round count, win rate). They appear in horizontal rows.

LABEL	
42	

← label style (10px, uppercase, text-muted)

← data-lg style (22px, monospace, weight 600)

- Background: bg-surface
- Border: 1px solid border
- Padding: 12px 18px
- Radius: 3px
- The number color changes semantically (green for positive P&L, red for negative, amber for featured, text-primary for neutral)

Tags

Category tags identify simulator types (Repeated Games, Winner's Curse, Negotiation, etc.).

- Padding: 3px 10px
- Radius: 100px (full)
- Font: 10px, uppercase, weight 600, tracking 0.07em
- Color: category-specific (each simulator category has an assigned color)
- Background: category color at 10% opacity
- Border: 1px solid category color at 18% opacity

Pills (Filter Selectors)

Pills are togglable selection chips used for opponent strategies, parameter presets, and bidder counts.

Inactive state:

- Border: 1.5px solid border
- Background: transparent
- Text: text-muted
- Font: 12px, weight 400

Active state:

- Border: 1.5px solid [accent color]
- Background: [accent color] at 10% opacity
- Text: [accent color]
- Font: 12px, weight 500

Cards (Simulator Library)

Simulator cards on the homepage follow a consistent structure.

[Tag: Category]	[Status]
Simulator Name →	
Description text spanning two or three lines of body-sm.	
Finance application context	

- Background: bg-surface
- Border: 1px solid border
- Padding: 18px
- Radius: 3px
- Hover (live simulators): bg-surface-hover, border-strong
- Coming-soon simulators: 50% opacity, no hover, no cursor pointer

Insight Panels

Post-game insight text appears in a bordered panel with a semantic background.

- Background: green-muted, red-muted, or amber-muted depending on outcome
- Border: 1px solid [semantic color at 18% opacity]
- Radius: 3px
- Padding: 14px 18px
- Title: body, 14px, weight 500, text-primary
- Body: body-sm, 12.5px, weight 400, text-secondary, line-height 1.65

Tables (Round History)

History tables display round-by-round game data.

- Container: 1px solid border, radius 3px, max-height with overflow scroll
- Header row: sticky, bg-surface, label style (9px uppercase), border-bottom
- Data cells: data-sm (12px monospace), padding 5-6px vertical, 10px horizontal
- Cell text color: semantic (green for cooperation/profit, red for defection/loss, text-muted for neutral)

- No alternating row colors. No horizontal rules between rows. The monospace alignment provides sufficient visual structure.

Input Fields

Used for bid entry in the auction simulator.

- Background: bg-primary
 - Border: 1px solid border-strong
 - Radius: 3px
 - Padding: 10px 14px
 - Font: data face, 16px
 - Color: text-primary
 - Focus: border changes to amber. No outline, no box-shadow glow.
 - Placeholder: text-muted
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6. Interaction Patterns

Simulator Structure

Every simulator follows a fixed vertical sequence. Users scroll through a single column — no tabs, no modals, no multi-panel layouts.

1. HEADER

← Back link

Title + Category Tag

Description (2-3 sentences, finance-framed)

2. REFERENCE

Payoff matrix, rules, or mechanism explanation
(always visible, not collapsed)

3. PARAMETERS

Opponent selector / bidder count / adjustable inputs
(pills or small controls, not dropdowns)

4. ACTION

Decision buttons (Hold Price / Undercut, Submit Bid)
Reset button (outline, right-aligned)

5. SCORES

Stat card row (your score, opponent score, round count)

6. RESULTS (appears after game concludes or round resolves)

Insight panel with adaptive text
Bid ranking (auction) or outcome summary

7. HISTORY (grows as rounds are played)

Scrollable table of round-by-round data

State Transitions

Pre-game → In-game: Immediate. No loading screen, no modal, no "Start Game" friction. The action area is visible on page load with active buttons.

Round resolution: Instant. After clicking a decision button, the result appears immediately. No animation delay, no suspense effect. Game theory insights come from patterns over many rounds, not from dramatizing individual outcomes.

Game over: The insight panel appears above the history table. The decision buttons become disabled (35% opacity). A Reset button is available to replay.

New opponent / parameter change: Resets the game state completely. History clears. Scores reset. This is deliberate — switching strategies mid-game would compromise the learning.

Hover States

- **Cards:** bg-surface → bg-surface-hover, border → border-strong. Transition 0.12s.
- **Buttons:** color shift only (amber → amber-strong). No scale transform, no shadow.
- **Pills:** no hover effect on inactive pills. Active pills maintain their state.
- **Links:** text color shift. No underline on hover — underline on default, no underline on hover (reverse convention for a cleaner look), or consistent underline.
- **Table rows:** no hover effect. The data speaks for itself.

Scroll Behavior

- The round history table auto-scrolls to the latest entry after each round (smooth, block: nearest).
- No scroll-driven animations anywhere on the site.
- No parallax effects.

7. Responsive Behavior

Breakpoints

Name	Width	Behavior
Desktop	> 768px	Full layout as designed. Hero side-by-side.
Mobile	≤ 768px	Single column. Hero stacks vertically.

Mobile Adaptations

- **Hero:** Mini-game moves below the brand text (column instead of row).
- **Simulator grid:** Single column cards instead of 2-column grid.
- **Stat cards:** Wrap to 2 per row instead of 3+ in a single row.
- **Payoff matrix:** Scales naturally (table is narrow by design).
- **Decision buttons:** Full width, stacked vertically with larger touch targets (minimum 44px height).
- **History table:** Horizontal scroll if needed, with sticky first column.
- **Page padding:** Reduces from 24px to 16px.

What Does Not Change on Mobile

- Typography scale stays the same. Do not reduce font sizes for mobile.
 - Color system stays identical.
 - Card padding stays at 18px.
 - The vertical sequence of simulator sections stays fixed.
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8. Voice & Tone

Principles

Economy. Say it in fewer words. If a sentence can lose a clause without losing meaning, cut the clause. Sagax copy reads like a well-edited research note, not marketing material.

Specificity over abstraction. "Play 20 rounds against six strategies" is better than "explore interactive game theory." "See why the winner systematically overpays" is better than "learn about auction dynamics." Name the number, name the mechanism, name the outcome.

Second person, present tense. "You bid. You win. You overpaid." Not "the learner" or "one might observe." The user is a participant, not an observer.

The insight is the reward. Every simulator ends with a brief paragraph explaining what just happened in game-theory terms and connecting it to finance. This paragraph is the product — get it right. It should feel like a senior analyst explaining something clearly over coffee, not a professor assigning a reading.

Copy Patterns

Simulator descriptions (2-3 sentences): First sentence: what you do. Second sentence: what happens. Third sentence (optional): why it matters.

Example: "Two firms independently choose pricing. Both hold, both profit. One undercuts, they capture the market. Both undercut, margins collapse."

Insight paragraphs (3-5 sentences): First sentence: what happened in this specific game. Middle sentences: the game-theory principle. Final sentence: the real-world finance connection.

Example: "You paid 112 for an asset worth 94, losing 18. Winning a common-value auction is Bayesian bad news — it means your signal was the highest overestimate in the room. With 8 bidders, the rational adjustment is to shade your bid well below your private signal."

Labels (1-2 words, uppercase): Labels name what something is, not what to do with it. "Your Signal" not "Signal Value." "Opponent" not "Choose Opponent." "History" not "View Round History."

Button text (1-3 words): Buttons name the action. "Hold Price." "Undercut." "Submit Bid." "Reset." "Next Round →." Never "Click here" or "Learn more."

What Sagax Never Says

- "Gamify" / "gamification" — Sagax is not gamifying anything. It is literally a game theory platform. The games are the subject, not a pedagogical trick.
- "Fun" / "enjoy" / "have fun with" — the platform is engaging because the content is intellectually compelling, not because it is entertaining.

- "Easy" / "simple" / "just" — game theory is not easy. Sagax respects the complexity and trusts the user to engage with it.
 - "AI-powered" — unless referring to the AI opponent strategies within simulators. The brand does not market itself as an AI product.
 - "Unlock" / "level up" / "achievement" — no gamification language. No badges, streaks, or progress bars.
 - "👋 Hey there!" — no emoji in any brand communication. No casual greetings in UI copy.
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9. Logo & Brand Mark

Primary Mark

The wordmark "Sagax" set in Georgia, regular weight, with the pronunciation guide as an optional companion:

Sagax / 'sa.gaks/

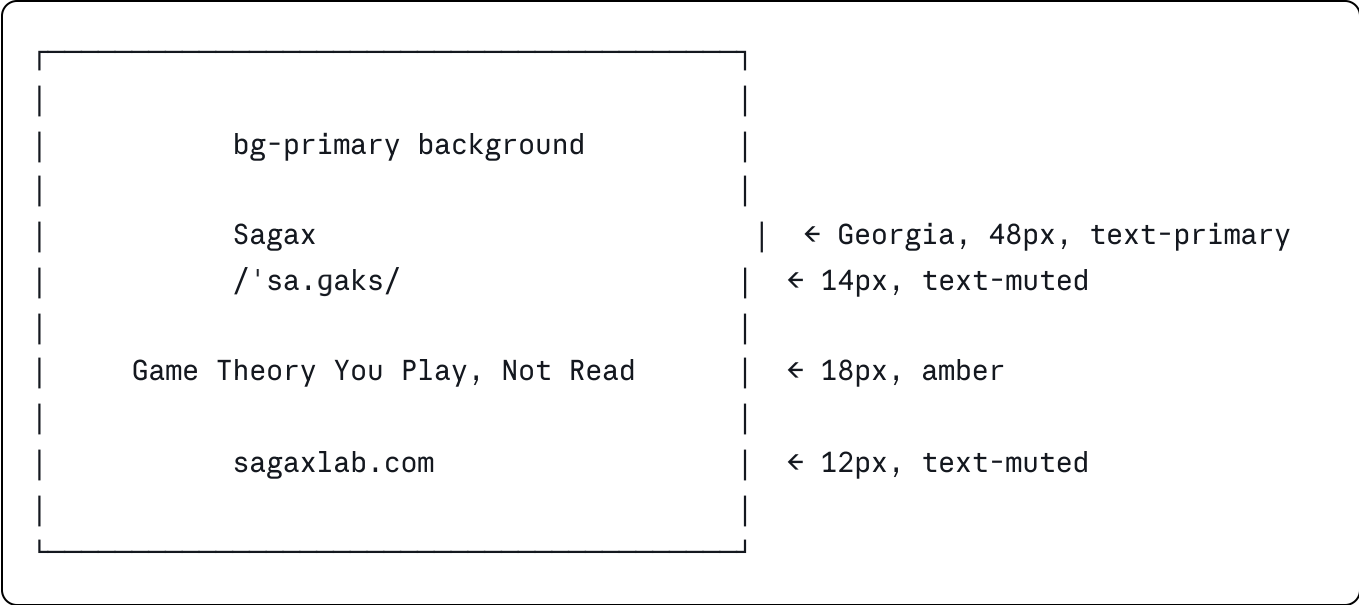
- "Sagax" in text-primary (#DDD8CE) on dark backgrounds
- The pronunciation guide in text-muted (#5E584E), smaller, with letter-spacing 0.08em
- The pronunciation guide is optional and omitted where space is tight (favicon, social cards, mobile nav)

Favicon

The letter "S" set in Georgia, amber (#C8963E) on bg-primary (#0E0D0B), within a square with 4px corner radius.

Social Card (Open Graph)

When shared on LinkedIn, Twitter, or messaging apps:



Dimensions: 1200×630px (standard OG image ratio).

10. File & Asset Checklist

Asset	Spec	Status
Favicon (favicon.ico)	32×32, S in Georgia, amber on dark	Needed
Apple touch icon	180×180, same mark	Needed
OG image	1200×630, social card layout above	Needed
Inter font	Loaded via Google Fonts or self-hosted	Needed for production
Brand color CSS variables	Defined in :root as per Section 2	In prototype
JSON-LD structured data	WebApplication schema on homepage	Needed
robots.txt	Allow all	Needed
sitemap.xml	All simulator pages + homepage	Needed